

On the occasion of Safer Internet Day, on Tuesday, February 6, 2024, a full-day hybrid conference titled "The Quest for a Better Internet" was held, organized by the Association of Learning Collaborators, HAKOM, and CARNET – National CERT, along with the Agency for the Protection of Personal Data as one of the partners. The aim was to convey a message about the importance of preventing electronic violence, protecting children's personal data, creating a safe virtual environment, and ensuring access to quality online content for children and youth.

As part of the conference, a round table was held under the title "Providing Support to Children and Youth for Safer Growing Up in the Digital World," where Anamarija Mladinić, a representative of the Agency for the Protection of Personal Data, spoke about the safe use of the internet by children and youth. Children are often unaware of all the dangers lurking on the internet; therefore, it is necessary to continuously educate them and raise their awareness of potential threats. However, it is also essential to educate adults, who often carelessly and excessively share personal data of their own and other children on the internet, thus acting contrary to the best interests of the child.

The panelists of the round table, including Bernard Gršić from the Central State Office for the Development of the Digital Society, Andrea Čović Vidović from the European Commission Representation in Croatia, Robert Tomljenović from the Agency for Electronic Media, Tomislav Ramljak from the Safer Internet Center, Tanja Zaninović from HAKOM, Jakov Kiš from CARNET CERT, and Neven Ricijaš from the Faculty of Education and Rehabilitation Sciences, agreed that by joining forces, much more can be done to enable children and youth to grow up safely in the digital world.

Safer Internet Day is celebrated every year on the second day of the second week of February, with the aim of raising awareness about security issues and dangers on the internet, which affect not only children but also adults.

The now traditional conference "The Quest for a Better Internet" brought together numerous experts who this year discussed the challenges of growing up in the digital world, data from primary and secondary school students, parenting in the digital society, protecting children's privacy online, and Microsoft's chatbot Copilot.

In the educational materials of the Agency for the Protection of Personal Data, you can find more information about personal data protection:

How to Protect Your Personal Data

Citizens, Know Your Rights

Guide for Employees in Schools